

BATROC

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Georges Batroc

OCCUPATION

Mercenary

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT

6 ft

WEIGHT

225 lbs

EYES

Brown

HAIR

Black

FIRST APPEARANCE

Tales of Suspense #75

(March 1966)

Self-professed master of Savate, the French form of kickboxing; allegedly an expert hand-to-hand combatant; does not have any superhuman abilities but describes self as Olympic-standard weight lifter with ability to leap vast distances; devises military tactics that serve to bewilder opponents.

BATROC THE LEAPER

Describing himself as the world's greatest mercenary and master of Savate, Marseilles-born Georges Batroc trained himself in this Gallic martial art while serving in the French Foreign Legion. Since embarking on a life of crime, Batroc has fought some of the world's greatest Super Heroes, including CAPTAIN AMERICA and the PUNISHER. Sadly, he has rarely survived these confrontations with more than the smallest degree of dignity.

Batroc is the eponymous leader of Batroc's Brigade, a motley collection of martial artists, assassins, and mercenaries whose membership is fluid. In the Brigade's early days, Batroc hired members for specific jobs, but most of the missions were unsuccessful. Employed to obtain the "seismo-bomb" from a foreign power, Batroc teamed with the SWORDSMAN and the LIVING LASER, but they did not succeed. Later, the RED SKULL hired him to attack Captain America. Although banded with PORCUPINE and Whirlwind, the mission failed.

Batroc has only scored significant victories with the British weapons master ZARAN and South American revolutionary Machete. During the Civil War (see pp. 84-5), Batroc was forced to work for the Thunderbolts Army. Afterward, he registered with the US government and trained heroes in the martial arts. He has since returned to crime. **AD, MF**

BATTLESTAR

FIRST APPEARANCE Captain America #341 (May 1988)

REAL NAME Lemar Hoskins

OCCUPATION Government agent **BASE** Chicago,

HEIGHT 6 ft 2 in **WEIGHT** 196 lbs **EYES** Blue **HAIR** Black

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Superhuman strength and stamina; can lift 10 tons; excels at hand-to-hand combat, gymnastics, and acrobatics; carries an indestructible adamantium shield.

After the POWER BROKER gave him his powers, Lemar Hoskins became a professional wrestler, along with his three pals from the US Army: Jerome Johnson, Hector Lennox, and John Walker. When Walker decided to become a hero named the Super-Patriot, Hoskins and the others formed the Bold Urban Commandos (the BUCKIES) as his support team. When the COMMISSION ON SUPERHUMAN ACTIVITIES chose to Walker to replace Steve Rogers as CAPTAIN AMERICA, Hoskins became Walker's new Bucky (see BARNES, BUCKY). Soon after, he changed his codename to Battlestar, after another African-American told him that the name "Bucky" struck a bit too close to the way slaveholders sometimes called their men "bucks." Hoskins continued as Battlestar even after Rogers returned and Walker became the US AGENT. After retiring from government service, Hoskins joined SILVER SABLE's Wild Pack. He sided with Rogers during the Civil War (see pp. 84-5), and later joined the Garrison, the Vermont team of the Fifty State Initiative (see pp. 118-9). **MT, MF**

